

Mikel *Rosenthal*

ART DIRECTOR · DESIGN SYSTEMS LEAD · SENIOR PRODUCT / UI·UX · BRAND · VISUAL DESIGNER

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I. SUMMARY

Senior Product Designer and founder of **PBK Studio** with 24 years shaping enterprise design systems, AI-augmented product experiences, and brand systems that scale across web, mobile, and emerging surfaces. For the past 8 years, focused on composable design systems — semantic theming, accessibility-by-default, and design-to-code workflows through Figma Dev Mode and Code Connect. Fluent in cross-functional collaboration with engineering, brand, and product for Fortune 500 environments including **Verizon, GE Healthcare, BCBS, and TransUnion.**

Unmistakable visual worlds, built to scale.

II. EXPERIENCE

PBK Studio *Founder & Owner*

MAY 2026 – PRESENT

DESIGN SYSTEMS · PRODUCT · BRAND · WEB · MOTION · VOICE · AI-NATIVE WORKFLOWS

Independent multidisciplinary studio designing composable design systems, AI-augmented product experiences, generative brand identity, and original music/voice work for enterprise and consumer clients.

- Engagements span enterprise design systems (healthcare, fintech, insurance), real estate microsites, brand identity, and responsive web.
- Deliverables ship with governance, accessibility, and developer handoff built in — Figma-first documentation and contribution patterns.
- Original music released as PitchBlackKnight; SAG-eligible voice performance for commercial, narrative, and sonic branding.

Verizon *Senior Design System Designer II*

DEC 2025 – JAN 2026

CONTRACT VIA INSIGHT GLOBAL · FULLY REMOTE

Senior design systems product designer on Verizon's mature, post-rebrand internal enterprise design system — hands-on, end-to-end design across matrixed iOS, Android, and web teams.

- Owned primitive and semantic design tokens, variables, and component architecture in Figma — driving cross-platform parity across iOS, Android, and web.
- Maintained and evolved the post-rebrand system, enforcing component quality, governance, and accessibility-by-default across products.
- Built scalable, polymorphic UI components — including a dedicated calendar / date-picker family engineered for theming and platform variance.
- Led design-to-code alignment through Figma Dev Mode and Code Connect; authored AI-augmented documentation and contribution patterns.

The Bettering Company *Brand Designer*

MAY 2024 – AUG 2025

FREELANCE · REMOTE / CHICAGO, IL

Built a new brand identity and lightweight design system, translating the company's core values into a cohesive visual language and shipping-ready guidelines.

- Generated and refined a wide range of logo concepts — exploring form, symbolism, and narrative to capture the brand's mission.
- Established brand guidelines and reusable foundations for consistent application across digital and physical touchpoints.

Avant *Senior Product, UI/UX & Design Systems*

MAY 2021 – AUG 2024

FULL-TIME · HYBRID / CHICAGO, IL

Led design and development of Avant's Pathfinder™ Design System and a marketing design library spanning product and brand.

- Defined visual language, component architecture, governance model, and contribution patterns for multi-platform consistency.
- Partnered with engineering to standardize UI through reusable Figma libraries and themeable variants.
- Introduced a brand/marketing design library that streamlined consistency for 350+ marketers.

GE Healthcare *Senior UX/UI Product Designer, Design Systems*

JAN 2020 – FEB 2021

CONTRACT · HYBRID / CHICAGO, IL

Designed, built, and evangelized the award-winning Edison Design System™ — a single foundation unifying 40+ regulated enterprise products.

- Developed scalable Figma component libraries and UX documentation across diverse teams and product lines.
- Central role in winning the 2020 Red Dot Award, Fast Company Innovation by Design, and dmi:DVA Award for Interface Design.
- Partnered with accessibility and compliance teams to ensure usability across regulated healthcare environments.

SurePeople *Lead UX/UI Visual Product Designer*

JUN 2020 – SEP 2020

CONTRACT · REMOTE / CHICAGO, IL

Led UX and visual design of the PRISM™ psychometric platform, translating behavior analytics into a cohesive, scalable UI framework.

- Defined interaction models, visual hierarchy, and IA for complex data visualization; built modular UI kits in Figma.

Blue Cross Blue Shield *Senior Product / Design Systems Designer*

MAY 2018 – DEC 2019

CONTRACT · HYBRID / CHICAGO, IL

Created and maintained the FIBER™ Design System — a React-compatible framework that accelerated product-to-market timelines.

- Defined typography, color, grids, iconography, and coded components with theming hooks for unified brand consistency.
- Partnered with developers to translate designs into React components; mentored teams in accessibility and documentation standards.

TransUnion *Senior UX Designer, Design Systems*

MAY 2018 – JUN 2019

CONTRACT · HYBRID / CHICAGO, IL

Designed the global TUCM Design System™ and visual identity for customer-facing and internal applications.

- Built responsive, scalable UI libraries; established universal style guidelines and design-to-code workflows.

Maven Wave *UX Team Senior Lead, Design Systems*

JAN 2005 – MAY 2018

FULL-TIME · HYBRID / CHICAGO, IL

Directed conceptual and visual direction across Fortune 500 client projects, integrating UX principles with brand storytelling.

- Established scalable design workflows and early design-system patterns for clients including Google, AT&T, and Nike.
- Created prototypes, journey maps, and digital ecosystems across app, web, and co-branded products; mentored design teams.

Biersma Creative *Senior Designer & UX Lead*

JAN 2006 – JAN 2013

FULL-TIME · CHICAGO, IL

Led visual brand and UX direction across healthcare, retail, and entertainment for clients including Aflac, AbbVie, Crate & Barrel, Disney, Google, Nike, Herman Miller, and Salesforce.

Firebelly Design *Senior Graphic Designer*

JAN 2002 – JAN 2005

FULL-TIME · CHICAGO, IL

Concept-to-execution brand and web design; print and digital for ComEd, Petco, Harris Bank, and Scholastic.

III. SKILLS

Design Systems Leadership · Composable Systems · Design Tokens (W3C) · Figma (Variables, Dev Mode, Code Connect) · Component Architecture · Multi-Brand Theming · UI/UX Design · Cross-Platform Parity (iOS · Android · Web) · Visual Design Craft · Brand Systems & Generative Identity · Accessibility-by-Default (WCAG 2.2 / 3.0) · AI-Augmented Design Workflows · Documentation & Governance · DesignOps · Adobe Creative Suite · HTML / CSS · Motion · Voice

IV. AWARDS & EDUCATION

2020 Red Dot Award — Interface Design

EDISON DESIGN SYSTEM · GE HEALTHCARE

2020 Fast Company — Innovation by Design

2020 dmi:DVA — Design Value Award

MSU Film Festival — 1st, Published Works

Missouri State University · Springfield, MO

BFA, SUMMA CUM LAUDE — ELECTRONIC ARTS & DESIGN

MINOR: MASS MEDIA & COMMUNICATIONS

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